



Volume 18, Issue 2

May 2013

Quarterly Meeting
 Tuesday, May 14 at 7 pm
 Tanglefoot Cottage
 607 - 37th Street

**Come for a Short
 Salsa Dance Lesson
 Refreshments Provided**

Business Meeting at 7:30 pm

West Side Neighborhood Earns Second National Register of Historic Places Designation

*North of Grand Neighborhood
 Celebrates Greenwood Park Plats Historic District*

Before the Iowa State Fair found its permanent home on the east side of Des Moines, it spent six years (1879-1885) on the west side in what is now called Greenwood Park Plats, 39th-42nd streets and Grand Avenue to Center Street.

On Wednesday April 24, 2013, North of Grand Neighborhood leaders were notified that Greenwood Park Plats was accepted for listing on the National Register of Historic Places.....*story continued on page 4*

Discussion Item for May 14th meeting:

Century Link New Utility Boxes

Discussion will be held during our business meeting on May 14th regarding placement of Century Link's new utility boxes throughout the NOG neighborhood.....
*story continued on page 2*

B Stylin'

You can order your new NOG t-shirt at our May 14th meeting @ 7pm or you can email Justin Gross at justingross2@gmail.com.

Please make checks payable to
 "North of Grand Neighborhood Association."
 As a reminder – S, M, X, XL are \$18, XXL t-shirts are \$20.



**Thank you to all who have supported NOG by
 ordering a t-shirt and please wear it with pride!**

NOG Neighborhood 2013 Awards

**These individuals will receive their awards at our May 14th meeting –
Come and help us celebrate their leadership with our neighborhood!**

Individual – Tom Wollan

The North of Grand Neighborhood laced up their walking shoes last August for a the North of Grand Architectural Walking Tour.

North of Grand resident and architect Tom Wollan, AIA, LEED AP, led participants through the western part of the neighborhood while noting historic homes, period architecture styles and why the neighborhood includes the styles it does. Wollan is an architect with Frevert-Ramsey-Kobes Architects-Engineers. The tour(s) were successful and we appreciate Tom's leadership!

Public Employee - AJ Russo Parks and Recreation Department

A.J. Russo - the Irrigation Technician for the City of Des Moines. A.J.'s role with the City is to start up, maintain, and winterize all irrigation systems within the city. On top of that, he also assists the City plumber on a daily basis to repair municipal buildings, parks restrooms, fountains, waterlines, pools and pumps. When winter roles around he is assigned to help Public Works in snow removal around the city. Outside of the daily duties he also is assigned to the North of Grand Neighborhood as our neighborhood liaison with the City Parks Department. We appreciate A.J.'s leadership and help with BridgePark!

Discussion Item for May 14th meeting:

Century Link New Utility Boxes

The placement of the additional boxes will be on either City right of way or on private property. The locations that are proposed are:

4105 Woodland	3929 Woodland	520 41 st St.
634 34 th St.	3013 Woodland	3414 Center

We will share the latest information that we have learned on their locations. Century Link will create further options for high speed internet in the neighborhood.

NOG Receives Polk County Community Betterment Grant for \$3,000

The funds will be used for:

Goal 1: Strengthen Community Connections

- Organize and hold a membership drive to build contacts among residential and commercial property owners and other residents while boosting revenues for future events.
- Develop digital and print communications outreach and promotional documents, outdoor yard signs publicizing events, printed brochures, newsletters, and Web and email announcements, including donated professional graphic artist services.
- Purchase liability insurance, street closure permit fees, live music, refreshments, tent and portable toilet rentals during various neighborhood events including crime prevention (National Night Out, children's parade), annual picnic, neighborhood garage sale. Neighbors get to know neighbors at these events, which is an effective method to reducing crime, and having fun!
- Funds will be used to enhance corner plantings and flower beds near the I-235 pedestrian bridge at 40th Street.

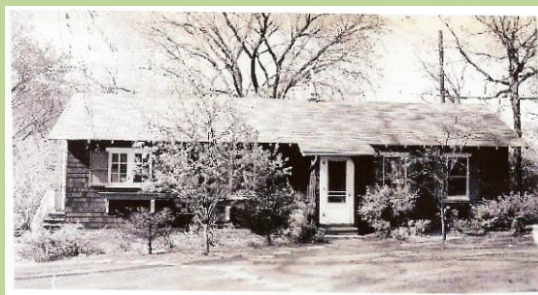


On the east side of Des Moines a young lady named Ethel Veatch started a dance studio in a loft above her father's meat shop. This was before shops had air conditioning and flies were attracted to the area, so Ethel hung flypaper strips from the ceiling of her studio. The brand of that flypaper was Tanglefoot – and her studio had its name.

When Ethel and “Dutch” Schmidt married they made their home at 3627 Grand Ave. and in 1927 a cottage was built in their back yard for Ethel's dance classes – Tanglefoot Cottage.

Lois Penn, a student of Ethel's, became owner and director after the death of Ethel in 1957. In 1970 Lois had the present Tanglefoot built at 607 37th Street. Lois continued to own and direct the studio until her passing in 2008.

The present owner and director, Jan Stewart, started teaching at Tanglefoot in 1960. In addition to the traditional ballet, tap and tumbling, she has added theater/jazz, hip hop and lyrical dance to the curriculum. She continues Ethel's tradition of an Annual Spring Recital at The Hoyt Sherman Place. Among other continuing traditions are age appropriate movement and costuming.



Original Tanglefoot Cottage located at
3627 Grand Ave Built in 1927



Tanglefoot Cottage 607 37th Street Today

Historic District Approved!

West Side Neighborhood Earns Second National Register of Historic Places Designation

Continued from front page –

culminating nearly two years worth of work. This is the second National Historic District within NOG, joining the Middlesex Plat National Historic District (31st-35th streets and Woodland Ave. to Center St.), which was listed in 2000.

“Our neighborhood is especially proud of its history and put many volunteer hours into making this designation a reality,” said Kimberly Hansen, NOG president. “We will now work with residents in this part of our neighborhood, as well as in the Middlesex Plat, to provide education on the benefits that accompany listing on the National Register of Historic Places.”

The 277 contributing buildings in Greenwood Park Plats, as well as those in the Middlesex Plat, qualify for the State Historic Preservation Tax Incentive Program, which provides a state income tax credit of 25% of costs for the rehabilitation of historic buildings and 20% tax credit for income producing properties. The incentives ensure character-defining features and spaces of buildings are retained and helps revitalize surrounding neighborhoods.

In addition to its significance as the first Des Moines location for the Iowa State Fair, Greenwood Park Plats also demonstrates early residential growth and expansion, serving as a node from which the western part of the city proper expanded in all directions.

The Greenwood Park Plats Historic District National Register Nomination Form (113 pgs., 15MB) is available to view at www.northofgrandneighborhood.org.

DID YOU KNOW??

It's May and spring is supposed to be here. Okay it has been teasing us with the on again off again spring like days, but, it will soon be here to stay.

The winter was pretty rough and we had some pretty good storms that left a lot of trees and branches down. I have already started an effort to remind everyone to get these limbs and brush cleaned up. A reminder on how to dispose of branches properly: You can tie bundles of sticks cut to the length of 4 feet or less and put a sticker on them. Stickers are purchased at Dahls or HyVee. You can also use approved Metro Waste Authority bags to put sticks, leaves etc. If you do not use an approved bag you must put a sticker on the bag just as you do the bundles of limbs.

You may also take advantage of the city's Mega "Scrub" days. Spring Clean up to Remove Urban Blight (SCRUB) is offered on the third Saturday of each month from March through November. On those days you may take your yard waste to the Metro Waste Authority Compost Center at 1601 Harriett street from 7 a.m. to 2 a.m. free of charge. Remember to cut your grass. Your neighbor will appreciate it. If your grass gets the 12" or more you may get a letter from the Polk County Weed Commission.

And finally, this will be my last Did You Know article for NOG. I will be transferring to a new area beginning July 1. I will miss working with all of you. I have found that N.O.G. takes great pride in their in their neighborhood and I truly enjoy teaming up with a group like that. I believe we have worked well together to accomplish many good things for the neighborhood and I will miss that.

Thanks for the ride,

Ed Leedom N.B.S.D. elleedom@dmgov.org

515-283-4183 – office

515-208-0299 - cell



For Sale By Owner

804 39th Street

1919 Arts and Crafts style house, 4 bedrooms, 2.5 baths, 2313 square feet per Assessor, with newly finished 750 square feet basement. Hardwood floors throughout. Owner has painstakingly refinished the house in all regards. The house has been insulated (prior to current owner, there was no insulation in the house whatsoever). The owner installed 14 new, energy efficient windows, consistent with the house. This house has been owned by the owners since 2001, and every effort has been made to restore it to its original glory. We are the fifth owners of the house.

Roof is lifetime shingles, replaced in 2008 with new gutters. Windows done in 2009. Property sits on 0.391 acres plus 0.4223 of DOT owned land (no taxes payable) for a total of 0.81 acres of land. This house is a one of kind, one that must be seen to be appreciated.

Asking \$250,000 which for 3,063 of finished space is a fantastic deal! Contact Dan Garrett
daniel_garrett@hotmail.com

Corner Plantings

Want to add some brilliant colors to an intersection in our neighborhood? It's time to sign up to receive free annual blooms to plant at the corners of intersections in the North of Grand Neighborhood.

The city will provide the flowers. We ask you to be responsible for planting, weeding and watering throughout the summer months. Why not ask a neighbor or two to share some of the tasks at an intersection near you? We have a Roto-tiller to help dig up the earth prior to planting.

Please contact **Mark Siegfried at 255-7667** if you're interested in planting and tending a corner plot near you. Plants may be picked up in at Mark's backyard, located at 4105 Woodland Avenue the 3rd week of May.

Calendar of Events

Corner Plantings –
Plants will be available the 3rd week in May

Neighborhood Wide Garage Sales
2nd Saturday in June

Neighborhood Picnic
2nd Saturday in June

National Night Out
2nd Tuesday in August

Ingersoll Live
4th Saturday in August

SPRING



The mission of the North of Grand Neighborhood Association is to ensure that existing and projected infrastructure systems are managed or developed so they enhance the physical, visual and spatial qualities of the neighborhood – promoting a healthy climate for area businesses, and public and private properties.

NOG Memberships

The process of how memberships are renewed has changed. Please print this form and mail your check to our P.O.Box. It is not too late to renew for 2013! If you have any questions - please contact Kimberly Hansen at 279-2684.

2013 Dues:

General Membership is open to everyone.
Voting members must live, work, rent, or own property within the NOG boundaries

Individual:	\$12 per year
Household:	\$22 per year
Business:	\$30 per year
Patron:	\$50 per year

North of Grand Neighborhood Association
P.O. Box 12027
Des Moines, IA 50312

2013 Memberships

Please consider joining or renewing your membership

We value your support!

North of Grand Neighborhood Association

Board of Directors

- **President:** Kimberly Hansen 279-2684
kimberlymhansen@aol.com
- **Vice President:** Mark Siegfried 255-7667
Marksally2@mchsi.com
- **Treasurer:** Matt Braafhart 989-1875
matt@braafhart.com
- **Secretary:** Sarah Oltrogge 971-4364
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- **At Large :** Mathew Coen 274-9513
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- **At Large:** Ben Molloy 277-4387
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- **At Large:** Colleen Kinney 664-9183
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- **At Large:** Nathan DeCock 943-6008
nfdecock@gmail.com
- **At Large:** Justin Gross 865-1468
justingross2@gmail.com



Neighborhood Based Service Delivery

If you have concerns about a problem in your neighborhood or have a question regarding city services and you're not sure who to call, please contact the following individuals: **Des Moines Police Dept. Sgt. Vince Valdez 971-0786 or City Code Enforcement Inspector Ed Leedom 283-4183**

Website: www.northofgrandneighborhood.org



Find us on FACEBOOK:
www.facebook.com/north.of.grand.dsm